Experiment 1: UI/UX Comparative Analysis (Athletic Shoe Retail)

1. Core Subject

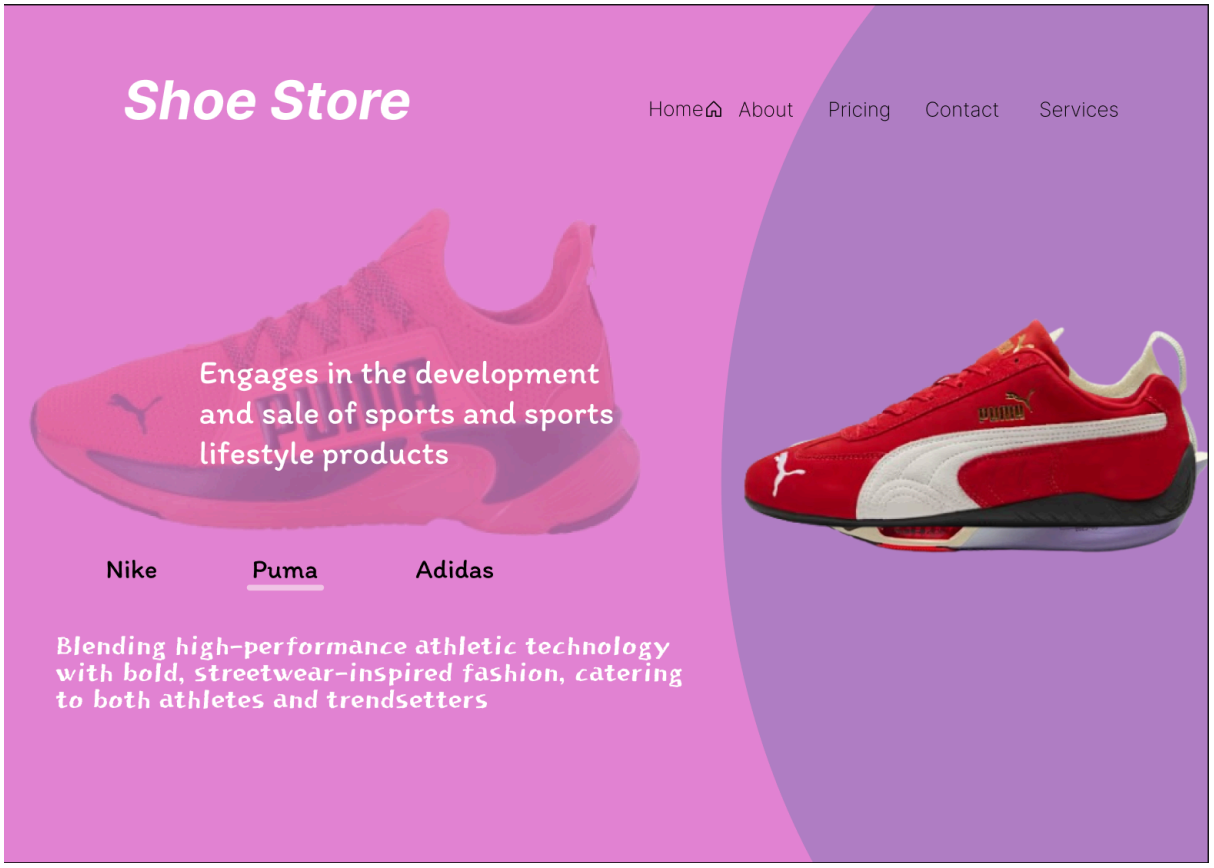
This experiment evaluates the application of Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) principles in an athletic shoe retail application. By comparing optimized designs against poor interface choices, we demonstrate how usability directly affects user experience.

2. Comparison Table

Property	Good Design (Nike/Puma/Adidas Screens)	Bad Design (Promotional Screen)
Clarity & Simplicity	Minimalist aesthetic with a clean background and intuitive navigation.	Cluttered layout with jarring, over-saturated colors (Neon Green/Yellow).
Hierarchy	Clear visual path: high-quality product images are dominant and well-centered.	Poor hierarchy: text overlaps and competes for attention; no clear primary focus.
Consistency	Uniform typography and standardized navigation tabs (Home, About, etc.).	Inconsistent font styles and sizes that do not match the brand identity.
Accessibility	High color contrast and legible font weights for product descriptions.	Low accessibility: Red text on a bright green background is difficult for many to read.
Brand Alignment	Modern photography and subtle use of brand colors.	Visual noise: unprofessional use of "Buy 2 get 1 free" text that lacks brand polish.

3. Analysis of Visual Samples

Good Design



Shoe Store

Home About Pricing Contact Services

Footwear that blends performance, comfort, and style

Nike Puma Adidas

Inspirational, innovative, empowering, bold, motivational, competitive, dynamic, and authentic

Shoe Store

Home About Pricing Contact Services

An item of footwear normally found in pairs intended to protect and comfort the human foot

Nike Puma Adidas

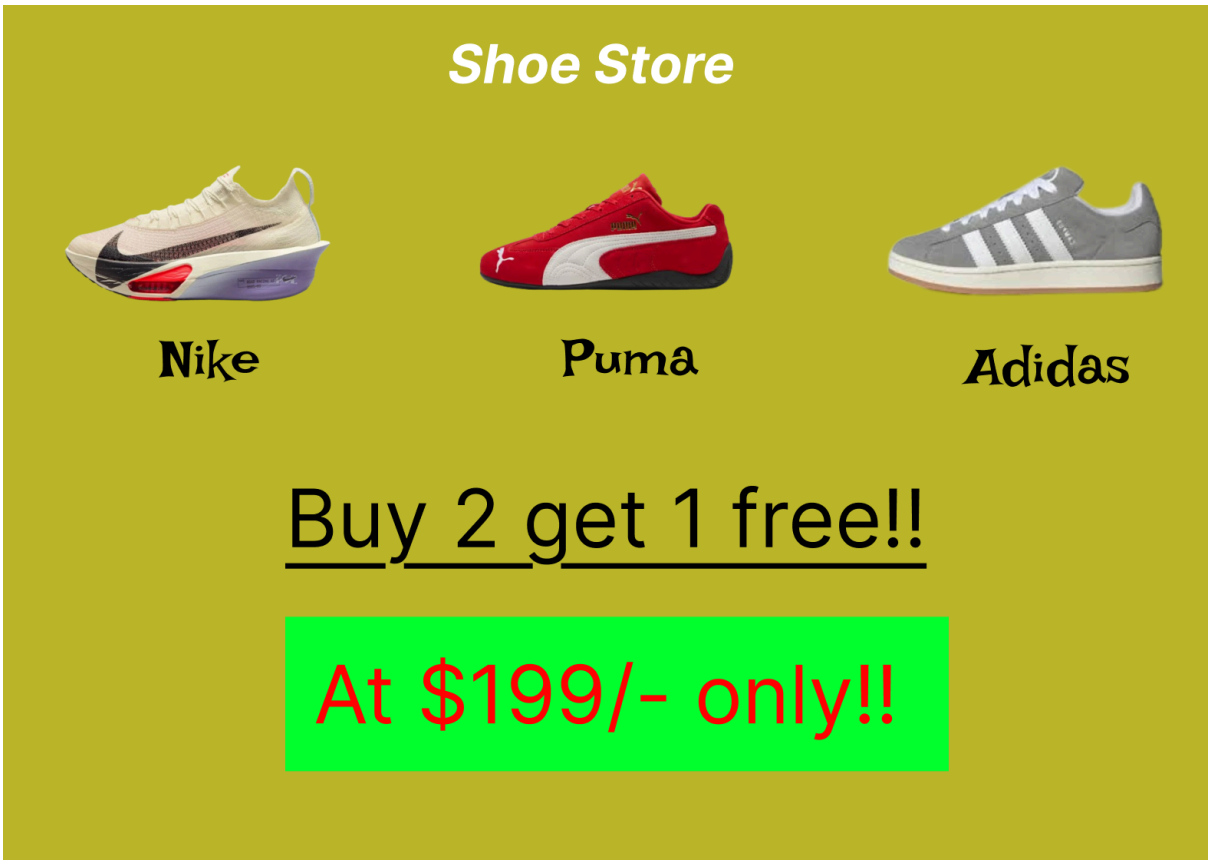
performance innovation of their shoes with major deep ties with sports culture, and durability with their focus of sport shoes, clothing, backpacks, and other accessories

Characteristics

The first three screens (Nike, Puma, Adidas) demonstrate a high level of **Consistency** and **Visual Flow**:

- **Dynamic Backgrounds:** Subdued pink and purple tones distinguish between brands while maintaining a cohesive style.
- **Functional Navigation:** The active brand (indicated by an underline) clearly informs the user of their current location.
- **Minimalist Messaging:** Focuses on brand values (e.g., "Performance, comfort, and style") without overwhelming the user.

<u>Bad Design</u>



Characteristics

The final promotional screen serves as a violation of **Aesthetics** and **Hierarchy**:

- **Visual Noise:** The use of "At $199/- only!!" in red over a neon green block creates an unprofessional, jarring appearance.
- **Scale Issues:** Product images are shrunk and lost at the top of the screen, while secondary text is oversized.
- **Lack of Structure:** The absence of a navigation menu makes this a "dead-end" page for the user.

4. Final Conclusion

Adhering to UI principles like simplicity and accessibility ensures that a retail application is functional and trustworthy. Conversely, ignoring these principles leads to an inefficient, frustrating experience that can alienate users and damage brand reputation.